



Regulation (EU) 2021/784 on addressing the dissemination of Terrorist Content Online Transparency Report

Regulation (EU) 2021/784 addresses the dissemination of terrorist content online. Google is committed to promoting transparency for the users of our platforms as to the action taken to address the dissemination of terrorist content.

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Overview

Google is committed to preventing terrorists from exploiting our products and services. Google's Terms of Service prohibit using any of Google's products or services to share terrorist content. Our teams work diligently to identify and remove this content, using a combination of industry-leading automated detection tools and specially-trained human reviewers.

This report describes Google's efforts and resources to combat terrorist content for the period from 1 January 2024 to 31 December 2024.

Measures taken to address the dissemination of terrorist content online

Information about measures taken by the 'hosting service' provider, as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation, in relation to the identification and removal of or disabling of access to terrorist content

Content produced by or in support of terrorist organisations is prohibited on our products that host user-generated content. Terrorist organisations are also prohibited from using our services for any purpose, including recruitment. In addition, our policies prohibit content that promotes terrorism, such as content that glorifies terrorist acts or incites violence. Google works extensively with government, law enforcement, and civil society groups to tackle the problem of violent extremism online and to ensure that there is no place for terrorist content on our services.

To enforce our policies, we rely on a combination of automated and human efforts to identify potentially violative content. Users can report potentially violative content via in-product tools. In addition, our automated systems are trained to quickly identify violative content. This includes flagging potentially problematic content for human reviewers, whose judgement is needed for the many decisions that require a more nuanced determination.

The context in which a piece of content is created or shared is an important factor in any assessment about its quality or its purpose. If users are posting content related to terrorism for an educational, documentary, scientific, or artistic purpose, we encourage them to be mindful to provide enough information so that viewers can understand the context.

Across our policy areas, Google continues to support the network of government partners and non-governmental organisations (NGOs) who bring valuable expertise to our enforcement systems, including through YouTube's Priority Flagger program. In the context of violent extremism, this includes

NGOs and government agencies focused on counterterrorism. Participants in the Priority Flagger program receive training to identify content that violates YouTube's Community Guidelines and, because their flags have a higher action rate than the average user, we prioritise them for review. Content flagged by Priority Flaggers is subject to the same policies as content flagged by any other user and is reviewed by our teams who are trained to make decisions on whether content violates Community Guidelines and should be removed.

Information on the 'hosting service' provider, as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation, measures to address the reappearance online of material which has previously been removed or to which access has been disabled because it was considered to be terrorist content, in particular where automated tools have been used

Google has long invested in automated, machine learning technology to aid in the detection of content that may violate our policies. Google products - such as YouTube - use this machine learning technology to detect re-uploads of violative content, in many cases before it is widely viewed by users. In addition, we use hash matching (or 'digital fingerprints') technology to detect known violent extremist content. Previously reviewed content determined to be violative of our policies is hashed, and these hashes are compared against other content hosted on our products. When a match is found, the content is reviewed to verify whether it indeed violates our policies. If it does, the content is removed and is used to train our machines for better coverage in the future.

In 2016, YouTube created a [hash-sharing database](#) with industry partners where we share hashes of terrorist content to stop its spread. In November 2023, the Global Internet Forum to Counter Terrorism (GIFCT) reported that the shared database contained approximately [400,000 unique hashes](#) that are near-identical to the human eye. Once content has been hashed, other platforms can use these hashes to help detect related content on their platforms and assess it against their own content policies. This organised effort is now formally operated by GIFCT, of which YouTube and Google are members. YouTube's vast media library and automated detection systems make us a large contributor of hashes to the hash-sharing database. In accordance with the sharing criteria established by GIFCT, YouTube contributed over 65,000 unique hashes to the hash-sharing database in 2024.

The number of items of terrorist content removed or to which access has been disabled following Removal Orders or Voluntary Measures¹

During the reporting period, Google received three Removal Orders² across its services from Competent Authorities under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation: two for YouTube and one for Drive. These orders resulted in the removal of three items of terrorist content.

Additionally, we removed 55,306,499 items of terrorist or extremist content³ due to violations of our policies and Community Guidelines, and as a result of legal removal notices.

The number of complaints and cases in which we reinstated such content or access thereto following a complaint by the content provider

During the reporting period, we handled 81,799 complaints (i.e. appeals) in accordance with our internal complaint handling mechanisms. Of these complaints, 75,736 original enforcement decisions were upheld whereas 6,063 original enforcement decisions were overturned.

The number of removal orders where the content has not been removed or access to which has not been disabled pursuant to the first subparagraph of Article 3(7) and the first subparagraph of Article 3(8), together with the grounds therefor

During the reporting period, there were 0 cases where content was not removed or where access was not disabled.

The number and the outcome of complaints handled by the hosting service provider in accordance with Article 10

As Google's services are not subject to specific measures under Article 5, there is nothing to report on Article 10 complaint handling. However, Google maintains robust internal processes for addressing complaints related to terrorist or extremist content.

¹ This includes services that may fall within the definition of a 'hosting service provider' under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation based on our current understanding.

² It is not clear whether all of these orders constitute valid requests within the meaning of Article 3 of the Terrorist Content Online Regulation.

³ While this includes content related to terrorist content, these removals are based on prohibited categories that do not precisely mirror those defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation.

The number and the outcome of administrative or judicial review proceedings brought by the ‘hosting service’ provider as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation;

The number of cases in which the ‘hosting service’ provider, as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation, was required to reinstate content or access thereto as a result of administrative or judicial review proceedings

During the reporting period, there were no administrative or judicial proceedings issued. Consequently, there is nothing to report on for these metrics.

Additional Information

- Complaints received from users between 1 January 2024 and 31 December 2024 are included in this report even if the content was actioned prior to the reporting period.